

Bentresh Stela (Louvre C 284)

Notes by Minh-Tâm Trinh

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Glossing Conventions

(May not match the conventions in my older notes)

()	text omitted by the scribe, but implicitly understood
< >	addition to fix a scribal error
{ }	deletion to fix a scribal error
[]	addition to fix lacuna, or addition uncertain

References

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11/17/25

(1) *Hr K3 Nht*
tw t h^c.w
dd ns.y(t) mi (I)tm

Hr Nb w
ws(r) hpšw dr Pdt 9

Nsw Bity Nb T3.wy
Wsr-M^c3.t-R^c Stp-(n)-R^c

S3 R^c
ht=f Mri-Imn R^c-ms-s(w)

Imn-R^c (2) Nb Nsw.t Psd.t Nb.wt W3s.t
mri ntr nfr Imn
ms.[tī]w R^c-Hr-3h.ty
pr.w h n Nb Dr.(t)
wtt n K3-Mwt=f
nsw.t n Km.t hk3 Dšr.wt
ity (3) it Pdt 9
pri m ht
sr(w) n=f nh.tw
wd n=f pri c m swh.t

(1) Horus, Mighty Bull,
 perfect [F 295] of appearance [F 185] [*nfr hr*],
 enduring of kingship [*nfr hr*], like Atum,

Golden Horus,
 strong [F 68] of arm [*nfr hr*] [who] drives away the Nine Bows [*pd.t psd.t*],

Dual King, Lord of the Two Lands,
 Usermaatre Setepenre,

Son of Re,
 his presence [F 200], Meriamun Rameses,

Amun-Re, (2) Lord of the Thrones [*cf.* G 627 and TLA 26200] [of] the Ennead, of the
 Ladies of Thebes¹,
 beloved of the good god, Amun,
 bo[r]n of Re-Horakhty,
 seed [F 91] of the *akh* of the Lord of Ancestors[? F 324],
 begotten of Kamutef,
 king of the Black Land², ruler of the Red Land³,

1 *W3s.t* = Waset = “The Scepter”.

2 *Km.t* = Kemet.

3 *Dšr.wt* = Deshrut.

sovereign **(3)** [who] seized the Nine Bows,
that when he came forth from the womb [second tense?],
victories [F 139] were foretold [passive] [F 235] of him,
command [F 73–74] [given] to him [while] active [F 91] in the egg,

12/7/25

k3 mn ib hb=f mtwn
nsw.t n ntr pri nh.t mi Mnt(w)
wr ph.ty (4) mi s3 Nw.t

is hm=f m Nhrn mi n(y)t-^c=f tnw rnp.t
wr.w n h3s.t nb iw<=sn> m ks.w m htp.w n b3.w n hm=f š3^c <r> phw.w

Bull firm [F 106] of heart [*nfr hr*], when he trots [circumstantial?] [F 158] [into] the
arena [variant spelling, F 121],
divine king [indirect genitive] [who] came [no gemination, so perfect participle] [in]
might like Montu,
Great of strength [playful spelling of dual -ty] [leopard heads?] [*nfr hr*] **(4)** like the
son of Nut:

So, his majesty [was] in Naharina like [that] of his custom [*cf.* H 248] each [F 305]
year.
[As for] the princes of every foreign land [F 185], they came in prostrations [F 287],
in peace [“peaces”], to the might [*b3.w* = mass noun?] of his majesty, as far as
the far north [F 92, last variant spelling].

12/21/25

inw=sn nbw hsb(5) mfk3.t h3.w nb t3-ntr hr psd=sn
w^c nb hr hrp snw=f
h^c rdi{.t} p3 wr n Bhtn in.tw in.w=f
di.n=f s3.t=f wr.t h3t ir.w[?]
hr sw3š{y} hm=f
hr dbh [nh] hr=f
wn (6) st nfr(.ti?) r 3 wr hr ib hm=f r ht nb

[As for] their tribute [F 22]: gold, lapis lazuli, **(5)** turquoise [F 106], every herb [F
183] from the gods’ land [were] upon their back[s].
Each one was outdoing [F 196, “getting ahead of”] his companion.
Then the chief of Bakhtan caused that his tribute be brought.
[and] put his eldest daughter in front of [?],
[and] was praising [F 216] his majesty,
[and] was pleading [F 311] [for] [life] from [“upon”] him.

[*wn* as imperfect converter? TLA 550129] The **(6)** woman had been pleasing
[stative?] to the utmost greatness upon his majesty's heart, than any thing
[else].

1/4/26

ḥḥ.n wdn(.w) nhb(.t)=s Nsw.t Wr.t Nfr.w-R^c
spr ḥm=f r Km.t
ir.n=s irty nb ḥm.t-nsw

ḥpr ḥsb.t 15 šmw (2) sw 22
isk ḥm=f m W3s.t Nh.t Hm.t Niw.wt
hr ir{y}<.t> (7) ḥs(ty) n (i)t=f Imn-R^c Nb Nsw.t T3.wy
m hb=f nfr n Ip(.t) s.t ib=f nt sp tp
ii.tw r dd n ḥm=f
wn wp.(wt) ii.n p3 wr n Bhtn iw hr in.w ḥs(3){t} n nsw.t

Then her titulary [F 138] was recorded [F 73] [past passive]: Great Queen Neferure.
As the king returned [second tense?] to the Black Land,
so she did every doing [which noun form?] of a king's wife [direct genitive].

It happened in regnal year 15, month 2 [playful spelling], day 22,
lo ["non-enclitic" particle, TLA 31760; see also F 30], his majesty [was] in Mighty
Thebes, Wife of the Cities,
[and] was doing **(7)** the rites [F 177] for his father [*f* for both *it* and *=f*?], Amun-Re,
Lord of Thrones of the Two Lands [TLA 26200],
in his fine feast of Luxor⁴ [F 16], his heart's place [direct genitive] since ["from"] the
beginning of time ["foremost time"],
[when] one came to say to his majesty:
There was [imperfect converter] a messenger [F 17, 60] of the chief of Bakhtan that
came, with[?] numerous [F 49] presents have come for the queen.

1/18/26

ḥḥ.n ms(.w)[?]=f (8) m-b3ḥ ḥm=f ḥn^c in.w=f
dd=f m sw3š ḥm=f
iw n=k R^c n Pdt 9 imi nn ḥn hr=k
ḥḥ.n dd=f sn-t3 m-b3ḥ ḥm=f wḥm=f dd hr ḥm=f
ii=i n=k it- (9) -y nb hr Bntrš snw.t kt n ḥm.t-nsw Nfr.w-R^c
mn 3bḥ(.w) m ḥw=s

Then he was brought [F 116] **(8)** before ["into the potency of"] [F 77–78] his majesty,
with his gifts,

4 *Ip(.t)* = Ipet = "The Adyton".

[and] he said, in praising [F 216] his majesty,
 Hail to you, Re of the Nine Bows! Give us life from you!
 Then he spoke [tribute], kissing the earth [TLA 888530] [typo for *t3* in De Buck?]
 before his majesty, [and] he continued, saying to his majesty:
 I have come to you, sovereign, lord, on [account of] Bentresh, the younger [“other”]
 daughter of the king’s wife Neferure.
 Illness has seized [F 2] her body.

2/1/26

im{t}{[?]} wd hm=k rh-(i)h.t r m3=s
h^c dd.n hm=f
in n=i tt(iw) nt pr-^cnh knb.(w)t (10) nt tnw
st3.n=f hr-^c(wy)
dd hm=f
mt(n) rti (tw) ^cs{t}.tw n {t}<t> n r sdm=tn mdw tn
isk in n=i hmw.t m ib=f sš m db^cw=f m k(3)b=tn
ii pw <ir> n sš (11) nsw tn Dhwti-m-Hb m-b3h hm=f
wd.n hm=f šmy=f r Bhtn hn^c wp.(wt) pn
spr pw ir n rh-(i)h.t r Bhtn
gm.n=f Bntrš m shr hr ^ch.yw

O [that] your majesty [would] command a wise man [missing determinative? F 151]
 to inspect [F 100] her.
 Then his majesty spoke:
 Bring to me the staff [TLA 177470] of the temple [“house of life”], the councils [F
 280] (10) of the residence.
 They were ushered in [F 255] immediately [F 175].
 Spoke his majesty:
 Look, it was caused that you were summoned [F 48] to this, in order that you hear
 [prospective] these words.
 Now, bring to me a craftsman [F 170] in his heart, a scribe in his fingers, [from]
 within your midst [F 275].
 There was a coming by a royal (11) scribe, this Thothemheb [*hb* on F 167], before his
 majesty.
 His majesty commanded that he go forth to Bakhtan with this messenger.
 There was an arrival by this wise man to Bakhtan,
 [where] he found Bentresh in the state [F 242–243] of [being] upon spirits [F 4],

4/19/26

gm.n=f (12) sw hry n ^ch3 hn^c=f
wn wr n Bhtn wh[m=f h(3)b m-b3h] hm=f m dd
ity nb=i im wd. {tw} hm=f rdi in.tw ntr[...]

(13) r hm=f n rnp.t sp 26 3bd (1) šmw sw ifd hb Imn

iw hm=f m W3s.t

[where] he found **(12)** him[self] an enemy [F 195] [L 370, 372] for fight[ing] with him.

There was [imperfect converter] a chief of Bakhtan that [“he”] relayed the message in the presence of his majesty, saying:

Sovereign, my lord, may his majesty command to cause to be brought a god[...]

(13) [to] his majesty in year 26, the first month of summer,⁵ day four [of] the festival of Amun,

while his majesty was in Thebes:

5/3/26

*h^c.n whm.n hm=f m-b(3h) Hnsw-m-W3s.t Nfr-h[tp] m-dd
p3 nb nfr ir=i whm m-b(3h)=k hr s3.t n p3 wr n Bh- **(14)** -tn
h^c.n st3.n Hnsw-m-W3s.t Nfr-htp r Hnsw-p3-ir-shr ntr 3 shr(i) šm3.w
h^c.n dd.n hm=f m-b(3h) Hnsw-m-W3s.t Nfr-htp*

Then his majesty relayed in the presence of Khonsu-of-Thebes Neferhotep, saying: [“The”] good lord, I make a report in your presence about [“upon”] [the] daughter of the chief of Bakh- **(14)** -tan.

Then Khonsu-of-Thebes Neferhotep brought [“pulled”] [F 255, cf. 253] to Khonsu-the-Provider, great god that dispels [F 238] disease-demons.

Then his majesty said, in the presence of Khonsu-of-Thebes Neferhotep:

5/17/26

*p3 nb nfr iw ir di=k hr=k r Hnsw- **(15)** -p(3)-ir-shr ntr 3 shr(i) šm3.w rdi.t šmi=f r
Bhtn
hn(n) wr sp 2
h^c.n dd.n hm=f
im s3=k hn^c=f di=i šmi hm=f r Bhtn r nhm s3.t n wr n Bhtn
(16) hn(n) tp wr sp 2 n Hnsw-m-W3s.t Nfr-htp
h^c ir.n=f s3 n Hnsw-p(3)-ir-shr-m-W3s.t spr 4*

[“The”] good lord, will[? Middle *in iw* to Late *iw ir?*] you turn [“give”] your face toward Khonsu- **(15)** -the-Provider, the great god that dispels disease-demons, to cause that he go to Bakhtan?

A grand nod [F 159] [TLA 98810], twice.

Then his majesty said:

⁵ *šmw* = Shemu = “Harvest”.

Give your [magical] protection [F 207] [Gardiner sign V16, substituting for V17] to
[“with”] him, [as] I cause his majesty [?] to go to Bakhtan to rescue the
daughter of the chief of Bakhtan.

(16) A grand nod of the head, twice, of Khonsu-of-Thebes Neferhotep.

Then he made protection for Khonsu-the-Provider-in-Thebes, four times.

5/31/26

wḏ.n ḥm=f rdi.t wḏ3 Hnsw-p3-ir-shr-m-W3s.t r wi(3) ʕ3
k3k3.(w) 5
wrr(y).t (17)
smsm[ti].w ʕš3.wt imnt.t i3bt.t
spr ntr pn r Bḥtn n km rnp.t 1 3bd 5
ʕhʕ.n ii.n wr n Bḥtn ḥnʕ mšʕ=f sr.(w)=f r-ḥ3t n Hnsw-p3-ir-shr
rdi.n=f sw (18) ḥr ḥ.t=f m ḏḏ
iw=k n=n ḥtp=k n=n
m wḏ.wt n Nsw.t Bity Wsr-Mʕ3.t-Rʕ Stp-(n)-Rʕ

His majesty commanded to cause Khonsu-the-Provider-in-Thebes to set out [F 75]
toward the great barque, [with]

five river-boats [TLA 159600],

a chari- **(17)** -ot [F 65],

[and] numerous beasts [TLA 135790?] [on] the right [“to the west”] and the left
[“east”].

This god arrived at Bakhtan at the completion [F 308, missing determinative?] of 1
year, 5 months.

Then the chief of Bakhtan came, with [Dieter: Ptolemaic spelling?] his troop [and] his
noble[s] [F 235] [footnote 1 in N: “uncertain”], in front of Khonsu-the-
Provider.

He put himself **(18)** upon his belly, saying:

[When] you come to us, you [are] peaceful to us,

according to [“as”] the commands of the Dual King, Usermaatre Setepenre.

6/14/26

ʕhʕ.n šmi.n ntr pn r bw.(t) nty iw Bntrš im
ʕhʕ ir.n=f s3 n s3.t n wr n Bḥtn
nfr (19) s ḥr-ʕ
ʕhʕ.n ḏḏ.n 3ḥ.t pn nty ḥnʕ=s m-b3ḥ Hnsw-p3-ir-shr-m-W3s.t
ii.t(i) im ḥtp ntr ʕ3 ḥr shḥ(i) šm3w
dmi=k pw Bḥtn
ḥm.w=k pw rmt=f
ink pw ḥm=k
(20) *iw=[i] šmi r b(w){t} iw=i im r rdi ḥtp ib=k ḥr iw=k ḥr=s*

Then this god went to the place in which Bentresh was [“therein”].

Then he made protection [Gardiner sign V17 this time!] for the daughter of the chief of Bakhtan.

Well (19) she became [“was”] in an instant.

Then this *akh* that was with her spoke in the presence of Khonsu-the-Provider-in-Thebes:

Welcome in peace, great god who dispels disease-demons [Faulkner 266: same spelling as the word for “foreigners”, but would take a different determinative].

Bakhtan is your home.

Its people are your servants.

I am your servant.

(20) I [spelled with the divine determinative!] will go to the place that I am from, will cause peace [to] your heart regarding [“upon”] that which you were upon [“it”].

6/28/26

i{w}m wd. {tw} hm=k r ir hrw nfr hn^c=i hn^c p(3) wr n Bhtn

h^c.n{n} hnn ntr pn r p3=f hm-ntr m dd

(21) *im ir p3 wr n Bhtn 3b.t 3.t m-b3h 3h.t pw*

ir wnn nn n ir Hnsw-p3-ir-shr-m-W3s.t hn^c p(3) 3h.t

iw p(3) wr n Bhtn h^c.(w) hn^c mš^c=f

iw=[f] snd.(w) r 3 wr

{h^c} (22) h^c.n{n} ir.n=f 3b.t 3.t m-b3h Hnsw-p3-ir-shr-m-W3s.t hn^c 3h.t

(w)n p(3) wr n Bhtn hr ir hrw nfr hr=w

May your majesty command [compare line 12] to make a celebration day [“great day”] with me, with the chief of Bakhtan.

Then this god nodded toward his [LE possessive adjective] priest, saying:

(21) Cause the chief of Bakhtan to make [prospective] a great offering [F 38]

[Gardiner sign M19] in the presence of this [Dieter: *pw* can be *pn*] *akh*.

During [“That there was making of”] this [Gardiner sign M22] of [which] Khonsu-the-Provider-in-Thebes with the *akh* did,

the chief of Bakhtan stood [stative] with his troop.

He was frightened to a great [extent?].

(22) Then he made a great offering in the presence of Khonsu-the-Provider-in-Thebes with the *akh*.

[There was then] the chief of Bakhtan making a celebration day for them.

7/12/26

h^c šmi.n=f p3 3h.t m htp r b(w){t} mr=f

m wd.tw n Hnsw-p3-ir-shr-m-W3s.t

(23) *wn p3 wr n Bhtn hr nhm r 3 wr hn^c s nb nty im Bhtn*

$\text{h}^{\text{c}} \text{.n } w3w3 \{y\} = f \text{ h}^{\text{c}} \text{ ib} = f \text{ m-dd}$
 $iw \text{ rdi} < = i > \text{ hpr ntr pn dy n Bhtn}$
 $bn = i \text{ rdi šmi} = f \text{ r Km.t}$
 $\text{h}^{\text{c}} \text{.n (24) } \{n\} \text{ tni} [?] \text{.n ntr pn rnp.t 3 3bd 9 n Bhtn}$
 $\text{h}^{\text{c}} \text{.n wr n Bhtn sdr.(w) hr } [??] = f$
 $mr = f \text{ ntr pn ii.n} = f \text{ r rwdt} = f$
 $iw = f \text{ m bik m nbw hy} = f \text{ r hr.t r Km.t}$

Then the *akh* went in peace to the place he desired,
as was commanded by Khonsu-the-Provider-in-Thebes.

(23) There was [then] the chief of Bakhtan rejoicing to a great extent with every man
that was in Bakhtan.

Then he took counsel [F 53] with his heart, saying,

I will allow this god to manifest here [spelled with Gardiner sign D37, as if *di* instead
of *dy*] in Bakhtan.

I will not [Late Egyptian negation, H §199] allow that he return to Egypt.

Then **(24)** this god ascended to[?] year 3, month 9 in Bakhtan.

Then as the chief of Bakhtan was sleeping [stative] [non-standard Gardiner sign Q2?]
on his [??],

he saw this god when he came from his chapel [“sandstone”, Gardiner sign T12] [F
148] [determinative: Gardiner sign O18?].

He was as a falcon [F 81] in gold, when he flew [F 48, spelled with *h* rather than *h*]
towards the heavens [F 175] of Egypt.

8/2/26

$r - \text{(25)} - \{h\} s pw$
 $ir.n = f \text{ m hnh} [??]$
 $\text{h}^{\text{c}} \text{.n dd} = f \text{ n p3 hm-ntr n Hnsw-p3-ir-shr-m-W3s.t}$
 $ntr pn wn.n = f \text{ di h}^{\text{c}} < n > n$

He a- **(25)** -woke [“There was waking”] [Gardiner sign D6] [F 152].

He made as [??].

Then he said, to the priest of Khonsu-the-Provider-in-Thebes,

This god, he is here with [u]s.